

Call Prep: Improving x Xero — Proposal Discussion

Date: Tuesday, June 30, 2026 | 6:30–6:55 PM CT (9:30–9:55 AM AEST, July 1)

Format: Google Meet — meet.google.com/wxb-ceuq-que

Meeting owner: Tristan Blom (Xero) — organized this call to discuss Improving's proposal

Meeting Purpose

Xero has Improving's proposal in hand. Tristan organized this call explicitly to discuss it. Three documents were attached: the Engagement Brief, the Infrastructure & Setup Guide, and the Visual one-pager. This is a proposal review conversation — not a pitch. David's role per Devlin's intro email: **leading Improving's executive AI sessions**, handling the workflow preparation piece (confirming data, access, and outcomes).

Your job in this call: own the pre-engagement consulting discussion. That's the \$40K phase — workflow discovery, data access, Builder activation, and outcome definition — which is exactly what you're being asked to address.

Attendees

Person	Org	Role
Tristan Blom	Xero	Organizer; People & Leadership / L&OD focus; Greater Sydney. Has Improving's proposal.
Brad Knight	Xero	SaaS GTM strategist at Xero — likely owns the business case and vendor decision
Rachel Burton	Xero	Optional attendee
Devlin Liles	Improving	Chief AI & Consulting Officer; authored the proposal
Blake McMillan	Improving	Head of Training; workshop facilitation lead
Stephen Johnson	Improving	VP South Texas (Houston); owns contracts, SOW, MSA
David O'Hara	Improving	You — leading executive AI sessions, handling workflow prep

The Proposal in 60 Seconds

What Improving is proposing: A two-phase AI Workshop for ~500 Xero employees in Denver.

Phase 1 — Pre-Engagement Prep (\$40,000, 6 weeks)

- Workflow discovery with 12 Xero functional leads
- Build a validated Stage 3 workflow catalog (one per functional group)

- Nominate and activate 18–36 Xero "Builders"
- Facilitate a Builder prep meeting (T-5 to T-7 days before event)
- Deliver complete workshop package T-48 hours before event

Phase 2 — Workshop Facilitation (\$75,000, event day)

- 500 participants, 72 tables, 12 functional groups
- 2-hour hands-on build: Do / Extract / Improve (3 exercises)
- Every participant builds and submits a Stage 3 task agent
- Post-workshop: Builder registry, eval scores, 30-day program proposal

Total: \$115,000. Both phases required. Fixed-fee, all-inclusive.

David's Piece: Workflow Preparation

You are handling the **pre-engagement consulting track** — the mechanism that makes the workshop actually work. Here is what that means in the proposal:

Your ownership areas:

Workflow discovery — 12 sessions with Xero functional leads (Finance, Engineering, Customer Success, Data, Legal, People & Culture, Marketing, Sales, Partner, Platform, Risk, Strategy) to identify the right AI task for each group

Data access & tool confirmation — confirming Claude access is provisioned for all participants and that the venue network allows it (biggest risk in the Setup Guide)

Outcome definition — what "done" looks like per table: a Stage 3 task agent with defined Input, Rules, Output, and an eval harness scoring 14/20 or better

Builder program — identifying and prepping the 18–36 internal Xero participants who anchor each functional group's table

The infrastructure concern Xero needs to address:

The Setup Guide flags AI tool access as the highest-risk item. The workshop runs on Claude. Questions to get answers to today or by next week:

- Is Claude (claude.ai or Claude Teams) accessible to all 500 participants, or only a subset?
- Does the venue network block Anthropic endpoints? (common failure point at corporate venues)
- Is there a Xero IT lead who owns this track?

Context: Internal Debate You Should Know

Before this call, there was an internal Improving thread (June 25–26) about the proposal. Blake flagged that in a 4-hour test run with 9 participants, the group barely completed one task build. Scott Poulin raised concerns about participant skill range. Devlin noted the proposal may be "a fairly big swing" on scope and price.

Xero does not know this debate happened. The proposal you sent them is the full \$115K version. **Do not introduce these concerns unprompted.** If Xero asks about timing or scope, you can affirm that the pre-engagement prep is what de-risks the workshop — that's exactly true and exactly what the 6-week phase is

designed to do.

If scope becomes a discussion point, the clean path is: *the prep phase is what makes this work at 500 people. We've designed it so the workshop team executes against a complete package — no improvisation.*

Suggested Agenda (25 minutes)

Time	Block
0:00–3:00	Open — Tristan frames the call; thank them for moving quickly on the proposal
3:00–10:00	Xero's reaction — let them talk first. What questions do they have? What resonated?
10:00–18:00	Address their questions; David takes the pre-engagement/workflow piece
18:00–23:00	Infrastructure & access — confirm Claude access, IT contact, network considerations
23:00–25:00	Next steps — SOW, kickoff timing, 50% deposit trigger

Discovery Questions (if there's room)

- "Do you have a sense of your Builder population — employees who are already experimenting with AI workflows?"
- "Who on your IT side would own the access and network verification for the event?"
- "What's your target window for the workshop? That determines our prep team start date."
- "Is Denver confirmed as the venue, or is that still TBD?"

Anticipated Objections

Objection	Response
"\$115K is more than we expected"	"Both phases are priced fixed-fee, all-in — no overages. The \$40K prep is what makes the \$75K event possible at this scale. Without validated workflows and activated Builders, 500 people in a room is high variance."
"Do we really need 6 weeks of prep?"	"12 functional lead sessions, one validated workflow per group, 18–36 Builders nominated and prepped — that's the minimum to hand off a complete package. It's not padding; it's the work."
"Can we start with a smaller group?"	"We can discuss — but the design is built for scale. A smaller pilot would have a different structure and price point."
"We're concerned about Claude access for 500 people"	"That's the right concern to raise now. The Setup Guide is exactly the tool for resolving it. We need an IT lead from your side within the first two weeks of prep."

Xero Company Context (for the call)

- **~3.5M subscribers, 180+ countries** — cloud accounting platform for SMBs
 - **Major AI push in 2026:** Moving from AI as a feature to AI as the core engine. Launched **XeroForce** (natural language AI agent builder) in alpha, May 2026. Partnership with **Anthropic (Claude)** announced, plus OpenAI integration.
 - JAX AI usage up 61% in the last 3 months. Xero is clearly moving fast on AI internally.
 - This makes the workshop well-timed — Xero has executive mandate for AI adoption and is actively building the internal infrastructure to support it. The 500-person session fits their "drive usage and adoption" FY27 focus.
-

What You Need to Leave With

Xero's reaction to the proposal — positive signal or specific objections to resolve

Whether Claude access is confirmed org-wide and the venue network is clear

A named IT contact for the infrastructure track

Agreement on target workshop date (determines prep kickoff)

Next step: SOW / MSA to Stephen Johnson, or a follow-up call if they need more time

Documents Attached to the Invite (review before the call)

- Xero-AI-Workshop-Engagement-Brief.docx — the full proposal
- Xero-AI-Workshop-Visual.pdf — one-page visual summary
- 06-Infrastructure-and-Setup-Guide.docx — the document you own; walk Xero through Track 2 (Participant Devices & AI Tool Access) on this call